



Robert J. Dellinger

PH.D. STUDENT, ATMOSPHERIC & OCEANIC SCIENCE

UCLA Atmospheric & Oceanic Sciences, Box 951565, Los Angeles, CA 90095

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Oceanic & atmospheric scientist investigating how physical and social drivers of environmental change shape ecosystem patterns, processes, and outcomes across marine and terrestrial systems.

Educational Experience

PH.D. STUDENT, ATMOSPHERIC AND OCEANIC SCIENCES

University of California, Los Angeles (UCLA) | 2024 – Present

Advisors: Dr. Aradhna Tripathi & Dr. Robert Eagle

Research focus: Coral biomineralization and symbiont community dynamics under climate variability and coastal land-use change, integrating multi-proxy geochemistry with ancient coral DNA (coraDNA).

Graduate Certificate: Leaders in Sustainability, UCLA Institute of the Environment & Sustainability

M.S., BIOLOGICAL SCIENCES

California State University, Northridge (CSUN) | 2021 – 2024

Advisor: Dr. Nyssa Silbiger

Research focus: Quantitative marine ecology and biogeochemistry, examining the physiological and energetic responses of marine invertebrates to the combined impacts of ocean acidification and warming.

B.S., MARINE & COASTAL SCIENCE, AND B.A., INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

University of California, Davis | 2017 – 2021

Awards & Distinctions

Community, Equity, Learning, and Persistence (CELP) Scholar

2026

AQUARIUM OF THE PACIFIC

\$10,000

- Selected as one of fifteen recipients of the Aquarium of the Pacific's 2026 CELP Scholar Program, supporting students in ocean-related fields.

Ideas & Organizing Doctoral Award

2025

UCLA LUSKIN INSTITUTE ON INEQUALITY & DEMOCRACY

\$10,000

- Selected as one of three awardees through a highly competitive, cross campus review process, recognizing doctoral research and public programming committed to confronting systems of extraction and inequality.

Center for Diverse Leadership in Science Fellowship

2022-2026

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, LOS ANGELES

\$4,000

- Awarded to diverse leaders in science engaging in significant scholastic endeavors, community-building, and creating a positive impact in our communities.

UCLA Eugene V. Cota Robles Fellowship

2024

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, LOS ANGELES

\$120,000

- Prestigious UCLA fellowship recognizing academic excellence and contributions, providing multi-year funding and professional development.

Center for Diverse Leadership in Science Fellowship

2023-2024

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, LOS ANGELES

\$4,000

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship

2022-2025

NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION

\$138,000

- Highly competitive and prestigious fellowship awarded to recognize and support graduate students early in their careers who have demonstrated potential for significant achievements in science, technology, mathematics, and engineering.

Center for Diverse Leadership in Science Fellowship

2022-2023

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, LOS ANGELES

\$1,000

Department Citation for Outstanding Achievement & Contributions

2021

UC DAVIS DEPARTMENT OF EARTH AND PLANETARY SCIENCES

- Prestigious departmental award presented annually to top graduates in recognition of academic excellence and substantial contributions to the department.

NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Honorable Mention

2021

NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION

Geology and Marine and Coastal Science Scholarship

2020

UC DAVIS DEPARTMENT OF EARTH AND PLANETARY SCIENCES

\$8,000

- Award made possible by the National Science Foundation Scholarships in STEM (S-STEM) program and given to students who show promise as a Geology or Marine and Coastal Science major.

Bodega Marine Laboratory Ambassador Award

2019

UC DAVIS COASTAL AND MARINE SCIENCES INSTITUTE

\$3,000

- Awarded to students demonstrating academic excellence and provides funding for summer research and coursework at Bodega Marine Laboratory.

Professional Experience

RESEARCH POSTIONS

Graduate Research Assistant, Critical Ecology Lab

May 2024 - Jan 2025

HUBBARD BROOK EXPERIMENTAL FOREST (HBEF), NSF LONG TERM ECOLOGICAL RESEARCH (LTER) PROGRAM

- Conducted interdisciplinary research at the Hubbard Brook Experimental Forest (HBEF), examining links between industrial economic activity and ecological disturbances, particularly acid rain-induced changes in Northern Hardwood Forests.
- Applied a critical ecology framework to examine how structural racism and classism (resource allocation, residential segregation, and wage differentials) drive air pollution disparities and impact biogeochemical cycles.
- Synthesized and managed large-scale ecological and social datasets in R, integrating atmospheric chemistry, economics, and historical policy impacts into a broader Long-Term Ecological Research (LTER) framework.

Graduate Student Researcher, Quantitative Marine Ecology Lab

Sep 2021 - Sep 2024

CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY, NORTHRIDGE

- Designed and executed controlled mesocosm experiments to investigate the interactive effects of ocean acidification and warming on the physiological energetics of marine invertebrates to assess changes in energetic expenditure under future climate change scenarios.
- Collaborated on field and laboratory-based research projects examining ecological and physiological responses of marine organisms to changing environments, within the context of natural variability; applied various physiological and biogeochemistry protocols to support research objectives.
- Applied advanced statistical methods in R, including nonlinear regression, two way ANOVA, and thermal performance curve modeling, to quantify temperature dependent metabolic responses.

Research Trainee, Sustainable Oceans Science-Policy Program

Jun 2022 - Jun 2023

NATIONAL SCIENCE FOUNDATION NATIONAL RESEARCH TRAINEESHIP

- Training emphasizing the integration of policy into scientific research to bridge the gap between marine science and decision-making for ecosystem-based management.
- Participated in experiential learning through field trips, internships, policy workshops, and basecamp sessions with decision-makers and stakeholders, enhancing skills in science communication and stakeholder engagement.
- Presented research at the Sustainable Oceans Symposium, collaborating with scientists, policymakers, and resource managers to align scientific inquiry with policy needs.

Research Intern, National Oceanographic & Atmospheric Association

Jun 2021 - Aug 2021

NOAA FISHERIES, U.S. DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE

- Conducted histopathological analysis to assess the impact of contaminants on *Morone americana* (white perch) in an urbanized estuarine system, comparing tissue samples from disturbed vs. undisturbed sites.
- Analyzed gill, liver, spleen, and gonad tissue for histological markers of environmental stress, disease, and injury to quantify pollutant-induced physiological changes.
- Contributed to a Natural Resource Damage Assessment (NRDA) by analyzing fish tissue pathology and pollutant impacts, supporting NOAA's efforts to quantify ecosystem injury and inform restoration strategies.
- Presented research findings at NOAA's Student Symposium, communicating research outcomes to scientists and policymakers.

Senior Environmental Technician

Jun 2020 - Aug 2021

ECO-ALPHA ENVIRONMENTAL & ENGINEERING SERVICES

- Managed procedural development, equipment procurement, and technician training for federal and state water quality compliance monitoring programs (CA State Water Board).
- Compiled technical reports and ensured adherence to pertinent environmental regulations for client activities. Additionally, handled document formatting and drafted responses for statewide bid and contract requests.

Undergraduate Researcher, Bay Lab

Sep 2019 - Aug 2021

UC DAVIS DEPARTMENT OF EVOLUTION AND ECOLOGY

- Conducted a collaborative meta-analysis to assess the evolutionary, ecological, and anthropogenic drivers of the genetic diversity of reef-building corals globally.
- Attended weekly lab meetings to discuss research on genomics, physiology, and ecology in response to climate change. Engaged in discussions on genomic sequencing, evolutionary theory, and predictive modeling of climate change impacts on populations of marine species.

Undergraduate Researcher, Bodega Marine Laboratory

Jun 2019 - Jul 2019

UC DAVIS COASTAL AND MARINE SCIENCES INSTITUTE

- Designed and executed an experiment to assess the impact of microplastics on feeding behavior in *Lytechinus pictus* (white sea urchin) larvae, comparing algae and microplastic (<5mm) consumption.
- Presented research findings to the scientific community at the Bodega Marine Lab Symposium.

Undergraduate Researcher, Gold Lab

Jul 2019 - Sep 2019

GOLD LAB, BODEGA MARINE LABORATORY

- Studied the early evolution of animal life, particularly genes related to biomineralization and geochemical biomarkers in Cnidaria (corals, jellyfish, and anemones) using molecular paleontology techniques.
- Investigated moon jellyfish as a model organism to understand cell type evolution, tissue regeneration mechanisms, and developmental biology.
- Investigated the physiological and genetic mechanisms of anoxia tolerance and regeneration, contributing to the understanding of evolutionary adaptations to hypoxic marine environments.

Undergraduate Researcher, UC Davis Study Abroad

Jul 2017 - Sep 2017

'ECOLOGICAL AND SOCIAL ISSUES', LAKE ATITLÁN, GUATEMALA

- Conducted aquatic sampling to assess pelagic processes, biogeochemical gradients, and species diversity at Lake Atitlán, focusing on the effectiveness of native plants in improving water quality and preventing eutrophication.
- Established communication (in English and Spanish) with local and governmental stakeholders to explore the connections between ecological and social issues at the lake, in collaboration with local NGOs and researchers.

LEADERSHIP & SERVICE

Radical Imagination Coalition, President

Sep 2024 - Present

UCLA CLIMATE JUSTICE COLLECTIVE

- Campus wide initiative inviting postdocs, graduate students, and staff to craft bold, creative climate futures centering Black, Brown, Queer, Trans, feminist, disabled, and internationalist perspectives.

Climate Futures Studio, Co-Founder

Sep 2023 - Present

UCLA CENTER FOR DIVERSE LEADERSHIP IN SCIENCE

- Co-founded and co-lead Climate Futures Studio, an interdisciplinary collective advancing scientific communication through storytelling that strengthens public understanding and civic imagination around optimistic climate futures.

Queer Sol Collective, Board of Directors

Jun 2023 - Present

KUMEYAAY TERRITORY, SAN DIEGO, CALIFORNIA

- Queer and Indigenous-led initiative (2SLGBTQIA+) designed to strengthen community healing and connection to nature for QTBIPOC communities.

Marine Biology Graduate Student Association, President

Sep 2022 - Jun 2023

CALIFORNIA STATE UNIVERSITY, NORTHRIDGE

- Led readings on marine ecology, organized professional development workshops and outreach events, and created events to foster community in the marine biology graduate program.

Noname Book Club, Volunteer

Jun 2021 - Present

RADICAL HOOD LIBRARY

- Committed to distributing knowledge and promoting awareness on critical topics, including race, gender, sexuality, class, disability, and environmental issues, both within and beyond prison walls.

Anti-Racism Committee, Member

Jun 2020 - Jun 2021

UC DAVIS DEPARTMENT OF EARTH AND PLANETARY SCIENCES

- Proposed actions to curtail institutional racism that arises out of department structures, curriculum, and culture.
- Worked with students, staff, postdoctoral scholars, and faculty to make substantial changes to the department.

Gender and Sexuality Commission, Commissioner

Sep 2019 - Jun 2021

ASSOCIATED STUDENTS OF THE UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, DAVIS

- Reviewed and formulated recommendations for gender, sexuality, and sexual assault programs at UC Davis and across the UC system.
- Made legislative decisions on issues including domestic violence, gender equality, and queer/trans concerns.

ASSOCIATED STUDENTS OF THE UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA, DAVIS

- Establishing liaisons and achieving rapport with on-campus and off-campus bodies of historically marginalized groups who face barriers in terms of institutionalized and systemic oppression.
- Created new policies, programs, and legislation affecting said communities and their quality of life at the University.

Campus Ambassador

Dec 2017 - Jun 2021

UC DAVIS UNDERGRADUATE ADMISSIONS

- Represented UC Davis to prospective students, providing insights into campus life, academic programs, and student opportunities through tours and outreach events.

Teaching Experience

TEACHING ASSOCIATE

General Biology & Introductory Biology Labs

2021-2022

CSUN, DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGY

- Instructed introductory biology courses and labs, which included curriculum development, leading discussions, and evaluating student assignments to enhance comprehension of fundamental biology and ecology concepts.

GRADUATE ASSISTANT

Ecology and Society Lecture

2022

CSUN, DEPARTMENT OF BIOLOGY

- Supported course instruction as a graduate assistant by tutoring students, grading assignments, preparing course materials, and providing one on one academic support.

Publications

3. Eppley, M. G., **Dellinger, R. J.**, Curtis, L., Estien, C. O., Forg, L., Jones, A. J., Swank, A., & Lee, A. (2026). Where we go from here: Harnessing queer perspectives to advance practice in ecology and evolutionary biology. *Ecology and Evolution*, 16(3), e73063. <https://doi.org/10.1002/ece3.73063>
2. Eppley, M. G., Lee, A., **Dellinger, R. J.**, & Swank, A. (2026). There is no consensus on biological sex. *Ecology Letters*, 29(3), e70350. <https://doi.org/10.1111/ele.70350>
1. **Dellinger, R. J.** (2024). *Facing physiological constraints: The interactive effects of ocean acidification and warming on the energetics of an intertidal gastropod, tegula funebris* [Master's thesis, California State University, Northridge]. <https://scholarworks.calstate.edu/concern/theses/jq085t882>

Conferences & Colloquia

13. **Dellinger, R. J.**, Hawkins, P. S., & Pierre, S. (2025). *Linking social drivers to biogeochemical change: Inequality-driven emissions from distant sources and impacts on forest ecosystem function*. [Presentation]. NSF Long-Term Ecological Research (LTER) Project Review, Hubbard Brook Project Meeting. Vassar College. New York, NY.
12. **Dellinger, R. J.**, Hawkins, P. S., & Pierre, S. (2024). *Ecology through the lens of critical theory*. [Presentation]. UCLA Center for Diverse Leadership in Science Research and Outreach Symposium. University of California, Los Angeles. Los Angeles, CA.
11. Abbott, M. H., Huson, V., Dhayalan, T., Fajardo, C., **Dellinger, R. J.**, Reed, K., & Silbiger, N. J. (2023). *Intertidal foundation species alter seawater biogeochemistry at high tide*. [Poster]. Western Society of Naturalists, 104th Annual Meeting.
10. **Dellinger, R. J.**, Fields, J. B., & Silbiger, N. J. (2023). *Facing physiological constraints: The response of an intertidal gastropod (tegula funebris) to the interactive effects of ocean acidification and warming*. [Presentation]. CSUNposium. California State University, Northridge. Northridge, CA.
9. **Dellinger, R. J.**, Fields, J. B., & Silbiger, N. J. (2023). *Facing physiological constraints: The response of an intertidal gastropod (tegula funebris) to the interactive effects of ocean acidification and warming*. [Presentation]. NSF Sustainable Oceans Conference. University of California, Davis. Davis, CA.

8. **Dellinger, R. J.**, Fields, J. B., & Silbiger, N. J. (2022). *Facing physiological constraints: The response of an intertidal gastropod (tegula fuenbralis) to the interactive effects of ocean acidification and warming*. [Poster]. Western Society of Naturalists, 103rd Annual Meeting.
7. Wallingford, P. D., Pandori, L. M., Elsberry, L. A., Barnas, D. M., Chiachi, A. E., **Dellinger, R. J.**, Kerlin, J., Singh, R., Zeff, M., & Silbiger, N. J. (2022). *Dueling unicorns: Physiological and distributional comparisons of native and range-shifting whelks*. [Poster]. Western Society of Naturalists, 103rd Annual Meeting.
6. Bay, R. A., **Dellinger, R. J.**, Flores, J. A., & Rumberger, C. A. (2021). *Assessing the drivers of genetic diversity on coral reefs*. [Presentation]. UC Davis Undergraduate Research Conference. Davis, CA.
5. **Dellinger, R. J.** (2021). *Does industrial contamination in urban coastal rivers cause injury to wild fish? Quantifying injury from contamination to a key member of the estuarine ecosystem, the white perch (morone americana)*. [Presentation]. National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration Annual Internship Conference.
4. **Dellinger, R. J.** (2021). *Patterns and consequences of microplastic ingestion by larval stages of the white urchin (lytechinus pictus)*. [Presentation]. Bodega Marine Laboratory Symposium. Bodega Bay, CA.
3. Bay, R. A., **Dellinger, R. J.**, & Rumberger, C. A. (2020). *Assessing the drivers of genetic diversity on coral reefs*. [Presentation]. Western Society of Naturalists, 101st Annual Meeting.
2. **Dellinger, R. J.**, & Warneke, A. (2020). *Designing an effective science website workshop*. [Workshop]. Western Society of Naturalists, 101st Annual Meeting.
1. Vriesman, V. P., Sumner, D. Y., Rudolph, M., Rousseau, M., Oskin, M. E., A., Micheletti, Livsey, C. M., Hwang, L., **Dellinger, R. J.**, & Chidester, B. (2020). *Curtailing institutional racism in an earth and planetary sciences department*. [Poster]. Geological Society of America Annual Meeting.

Public Engagement

EXHIBITIONS

- *Imagining Climate Futures: Climate Storytelling 2075 Anthology II*. Climate Futures Studio. (2025). Queens Council on the Arts, New York, NY, NYC Climate Week Official Event. (Exhibition Curator). [\[Link\]](#)
- *Imagining Climate Futures: Climate Storytelling 2075 Anthology I*. Climate Futures Studio. (2024). Queens Council on the Arts, New York, NY. (Exhibition Curator). [\[Link\]](#)

PRESS AND MEDIA

- *Strike the Heart: The role of activism in climate advocacy*.: Conversation with environmental activist Kumi Naidoo and climate journalist Yessica. Written by Funes, Yessica. (2025). *Possibilities*. (Moderator). [\[Link\]](#)
- *Sea change: A diverse group of CSUN marine scientists are studying the nearshore effects of warming and acidifying oceans*. Written by Fairlee, Danielle. (2023). *CSUN Magazine*. (Interview).
- *What non-monogamy can teach us about climate advocacy*. Written by Abraham, Anna. (2022). *CurrentlyHQ*. (Interview). [\[Link\]](#)
- *IN FISH! Student Robert Dellinger celebrates National Hispanic Heritage Month*. Written by Soulen, Heather. NOAA Fisheries. (2021). (Feature). [\[Link\]](#)

WRITING AND BLOGS

- *Kitchen oceanography: Overturning circulation*. Written by Glessmer, Miriam, and Dellinger, Robert. (2020). *Adventures in Oceanography and Teaching*. [\[Link\]](#)
- *Our crude awakening*. Written by Dellinger, Robert. (2018). *Davis Political Review*. [\[Link\]](#)
- *Slavery in Thailand's fishing industry*. Written by Dellinger, Robert. (2018). *Davis Political Review*. [\[Link\]](#)

ROUNDTABLE DISCUSSIONS

- *Pathways to advance diversity, equity, and inclusion in California's coastal and ocean sciences: Proceedings and recommendations from a series of virtual roundtable discussions*. California Ocean Science Trust. (2022). (Participant). [\[Link\]](#)

- *Opportunities and actions in ocean science and technology*. White House Subcommittee on Ocean Science and Technology. (2022). (Participant).

Skills

LANGUAGE SKILLS

Bilingual (English, Spanish) & Programming (R, MATLAB, Python, LaTeX, CSS, HTML)

COMPUTER SKILLS

Univariate and multivariate statistics and modeling (Excel, R, MATLAB, Python, JMP), including hypothesis testing, nonlinear approaches, computational modelling, and quantitative workflows used in ecology, biogeochemistry, and environmental datasets. Reproducible research workflows (scripted analyses, documented methods, version controlled outputs), including Git and GitHub for collaboration and code review. Data visualization and scientific figure preparation, and database and data management. Productivity and collaboration platforms, including Microsoft 365 (Word, Excel, PowerPoint) and Google Workspace (Docs, Sheets, Drive). Bioinformatics tools (BLAST) and image analysis (ImageJ). Design and media production tools (Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator), and web design (Adobe Dreamweaver).

RESEARCH SKILLS

Environmental compliance and review, technical documentation, and environmental data analysis. Field and laboratory methods including environmental and aquatic sampling, experimental design and experimental system management, project management, carbonate chemistry monitoring and titrations (pH, total alkalinity, carbonate system calculations), microscopy and confocal microscopy, mass spectrometry (ICP-MS), micro pipetting, serial dilutions, basic animal husbandry, and contaminant related injury screening and reporting. Scientific writing, statistical data analysis, interdisciplinary collaboration, science communication, and stakeholder engagement. Boating safety training and field safety preparedness.

COMMUNICATION & POLICY

Scientific writing and communication across academic, policy, and public audiences, including conference presentations, technical reporting, community outreach, and public facing exhibitions. Stakeholder engagement and facilitation experience in cohort based and collaborative settings, translating complex climate and ecosystem science into accessible narratives. Policy research and legislative analysis, geospatial and demographic analysis, and climate/environmental justice informed framing. Critical theory informed research practice and LGBTQ+/QTBIPOC advocacy experience, with a focus on community grounded science and education.

Professional Memberships

- Society for Advancement of Chicanos/Hispanics & Native Americans in Science (SACNAS)
- American Society of Limnology and Oceanography (ASLO)
- Ecological Society of America (ESA)
- Sigma Xi

References

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